

MODERN ENGLISH**LITERATURE IN ENGLISH**

(Prescribed Texts)

Maximum Marks: 80**Time Allowed: Three Hours***Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes***Instructions to Candidates**

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for only reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **five** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Section A, you are required to write only **ONE** option as the correct answer.
7. Internal choice has been given in the long answer questions on Drama, Prose and Poetry.
8. Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions in Section B.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

Kindly read aloud the Instructions given above to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

SECTION A – 20 MARKS**Question 1**

Choose the correct options for the following questions.

- (i) Which visitors arrive at Mrs Higgins' 'at home' in Act III of the play, *Pygmalion*, besides Higgins, Pickering and Eliza? (*Recall*) [1]
- (a) Mrs Eynsford Hill, Clara and Freddy
 - (b) Mrs Pearce and Doolittle
 - (c) Nepommuck and the ambassador
 - (d) Ezra D. Wannafeller and his lawyer
- (ii) In Act V of the play, *Pygmalion*, why does Mrs Higgins ask Doolittle to step out on to the balcony before Eliza comes down? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) Because she is ashamed of his manners in front of her guests
 - (b) Because Higgins wishes to speak to Eliza alone
 - (c) So that Eliza is not shocked by his news before she has settled matters with Higgins and Pickering
 - (d) Because Doolittle wants to rehearse his wedding speech

- (iii) Read the two statements from the play, *Pygmalion*, and choose the correct option from the ones given below. [1]
- Statement I:** Pickering always calls Eliza Miss Doolittle and stands up when she enters the room.
- Statement II:** In Act V Eliza says that her real education began with Pickering's manners. (*Understand*)
- Statements I and II are similar.
 - Statement I and II are unrelated to each other.
 - Statement I is the result of Statement II.
 - Statement II is the result of Statement I.
- (iv) In Act IV of the play, *Pygmalion*, Higgins storms out after throwing the ring into the fire, and Eliza is left feeling triumphant. Why? (*Interpret*) [1]
- She has found the ring and means to keep it.
 - For once she has made him lose his temper and got the better of him.
 - She has heard Freddy outside the window.
 - She has just won Higgins's bet for him.
- (v) In the short story, *The Dreamer*, what kind of look does Cyprian have? (*Recall*) [1]
- The dreamy, far-away look of a poet or a house agent
 - The sharp, watchful look of a shopkeeper
 - The bored look of a schoolboy
 - The anxious look of a young clerk
- (vi) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, what does Charles notice about the eyes of the thing that comes in to dinner? (*Recall*) [1]
- They are red and swollen.
 - They are kind but tired.
 - They are hidden behind dark glasses.
 - They are hard and dark, without any feeling.
- (vii) In the short story, *Games at Twilight*, what are the other children doing when Ravi finally runs to the den? (*Understand*) [1]
- Still searching for him
 - Playing a slow, solemn funeral game in a ring
 - Quarrelling about who should be 'It'
 - Sitting indoors out of the heat
- (viii) In the poem, *The Black Santa*, what does Santa's bony lap suggest about him? (*Understand*) [1]
- He is an athlete who keeps himself fit.
 - He is too old to hold the children.
 - He is a thin, poor man, not the plump Santa of advertisements.
 - He is uncomfortable in his costume.

- (ix) In the poem, *Refugee Blues*, each stanza ends with an address to “my dear”. What is the effect of this refrain? (*Analyse*) [1]
- (a) It keeps a note of tenderness and intimacy alive amid despair.
- (b) It shows that the speaker is writing a love letter.
- (c) It makes the poem cheerful and light.
- (d) It suggests that the speaker is speaking to a child.
- (x) In the poem, *My Grandmother’s House*, what does the poet express by saying that her blood turned cold like the moon? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) Her fear of the snakes in the house
- (b) The chill of grief and lost warmth after her grandmother’s death
- (c) The cold climate of the place where the house stands
- (d) Her anger at the people who now live in the house

Question 2

Answer any **five** of the following subparts in 40-50 words.

- (i) In Act III of the play, *Pygmalion*, what does Clara’s eager imitation of Eliza’s talk reveal about her? (*Interpret*) [2]
- (ii) In Act III of the play, *Pygmalion*, what does Mrs Higgins mean when she calls Eliza a triumph of Higgins’s art and of her dressmaker’s? (*Interpret*) [2]
- (iii) In the short story, *The Dreamer*, why does Adela Chemping take her nephew Cyprian with her to the sales? (*Recall*) [2]
- (iv) In the short story, *Death by Scrabble*, how does the heat of the day add to the narrator’s state of mind? (*Understand*) [2]
- (v) In the poem, *The Black Santa*, what does the description of Santa as shaky and thin suggest about him? (*Understand*) [2]
- (vi) In the poem, *Refugee Blues*, why does the speaker mention the poodle in a jacket and the cat let in through a door? (*Interpret*) [2]

SECTION B – 60 MARKS

PYGMALION: GEORGE BERNARD SHAW

Question 3

- (i) In Act V, how does Eliza react when her father suddenly appears? What does the moment show about her new self? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Understand*)

- Her reaction
- What it reveals about her transformation

- (ii) In Act V, Eliza tells Higgins that she may marry Freddy. What does Freddy offer her that Higgins does not? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(Understand)

- What Eliza says about Freddy
- What Freddy gives her

- (iii) (a) How does Shaw explore the relationship between speech and class in Acts III to V of the play? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Analyse)

OR

- (b) What does Higgins's relationship with his mother reveal about him? Refer to Acts III and V of the play. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Evaluate)

PERSPECTIVES: A COLLECTION OF SHORT STORIES

Question 4

- (i) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, what kind of girl is Isabel Burnell? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(Understand)

- With her sisters
- At school

- (ii) How does the narrator of the short story, *Death by Scrabble*, see his wife as they play? What does his description reveal about him? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(Interpret)

- The wife's behaviour during the game
- What it shows about the narrator

- (iii) (a) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, Charles proves braver and wiser than the adults around him. Do you agree? Give reasons. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Evaluate)

OR

- (b) How does Anita Desai present the world of children in the short story, *Games at Twilight*, as a small society with its own power and cruelty? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Analyse)

REFLECTIONS: A COLLECTION OF POEMS

Question 5

- (i) In the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, why does the poet wish to return to the house? Why can she never truly go back? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.

(Interpret)

- Her reasons for wanting to return
- What makes a real return impossible

- (ii) In the closing stanzas of the poem, *Refugee Blues*, the speaker describes a dream and a scene in the snow. What do these images convey? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.

(Understand)

- The dream of the great building
- The final scene in the snow

- (iii) (a) Comment on the title of the poem, *Urban*. Suggest an alternative title and give reasons for your choice. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Evaluate)

OR

- (b) The poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, celebrates community and the shared meal rather than the tomato alone. Do you agree? Give reasons. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Evaluate)

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